

AZ.4 Where to File Directory

Fifteen counties, the big cities, the two opt-out counties, the no-code county and the three state agencies — as their own sites name them, September 2026.

Before you use this document

This is a process reference, not legal advice. Arizona adopts no statewide residential building code — every code that binds a house is adopted locally, by ordinance, and the edition on your permit is whatever your city or county's adopting ordinance says it is. What is **not** local: a county building permit is required by statute for any construction over \$1,000, and inside a city the city's own permit ordinance governs; the owner-builder exemption, the signed statement you file with every permit application, the septic general permit and the well rules are all state law and apply whether or not anyone will ever inspect the framing. The unit is the **jurisdiction** — a city inside a county routinely differs from the county around it, and the city has statutory permit clocks the county does not. Confirm every item with the office that will actually handle your parcel before you rely on it. Every web address here was checked in September 2026. The Registrar, ADEQ and ADWR sites refuse automated requests and open only in a browser — if a link checker tells you they are down, they are not. Where a county's site refused every request, the office is named from the county's own archived documents and marked confirm.

THE RULE OF THE ROAD

Two things before any address

	Rule
1	Inside city or town limits, the city's ordinance governs; outside, the county's. The two routinely differ, and only the city permit carries the § 9-835 clocks (AZ.3). Ask for the adopting ordinance number — the ordinance, "published in full" and filed with the clerk, is the authority (A.R.S. § 9-802; § 11-864) — and take the handout you are owed at application (§ 9-836(A); § 11-1606).
2	Septic is a different office, and it is the county's even inside a city. ADEQ delegates its onsite program under A.R.S. § 49-107(A) to one agency per county — a development-services division in nine, a health department in four, Maricopa's Environmental Services Department, and one (Cochise) its pages do not name. Named below.

THE FIFTEEN COUNTIES — BUILDING PERMIT AND SEPTIC, AS THEIR OWN SITES NAME THEM

Code editions for each are in AZ.2. Addresses longer than a line are given as site → page.

Unincorporated areas — verified September 2026

County	Building permit · Septic program
Maricopa	Building: Planning & Development — maricopa.gov/2753/Adopted-Regulations . The county FAQ: "Written documentation of an Arizona licensed contractor or owner-builder classification is required for all building permits per state law" (citing § 32-1169). Septic: Environmental Services Department — maricopa.gov/1631/Onsite-Wastewater-Septic-Systems
Pima	Building: Development Services — pima.gov/1038/Building-Permits-Resources Septic: Development Services, On-Site Wastewater — pima.gov/1086/On-Site-Wastewater-Treatment-Facilities
Pinal	Building: Building Safety — pinal.gov/189/Building-Safety Septic: Aquifer Protection Division ("delegated by ADEQ") — pinal.gov/185/Wells-Septic
Yavapai	Building: Development Services — yavapaiaz.gov/Development-and-Permits/Codes-Ordinances Septic: Environmental Services Unit of Development Services — yavapaiaz.gov → Development Services → Environmental Services Unit
Mohave	Building: Development Services, Building Division — mohave.gov/departments/development-services/building-division/ (the permit application carries the exemption checkbox and block) Septic: Environmental Quality / Waste Disposal ("delegated ... by ADEQ") — publishes an "On-Site Wastewater Application for Owner/Builders" as an owner-builder packet
Cochise	Building: Development Services, Building Safety — cochise.az.gov/211/Building-Safety (2024 codes from 1 Sep 2026). Owner-Builder Amendment: cochise.az.gov/212/Owner-Builder-Amendment , with the amendment text linked as a PDF Septic: not stated on the county pages read; the amendment refers to "Cochise County Environmental Health Department regulations" — confirm the office at the counter
Coconino	Building: Community Development — coconino.az.gov/2391/Building-Codes-Ordinances-Design-Criteri . AMMP: coconino.az.gov/2173/Alternative-Methods-and-Materials-Permit Septic: Community Development, Environmental Quality Division — coconino.az.gov/1156/Environmental-Quality
Navajo	Building: Planning & Development Services — navajocountyaz.gov/289/Building-Information Septic: Planning & Development Services (its Environmental Health page says it "does not inspect new septic systems")
Apache	Building: the county site refused every request in September 2026; the code editions in AZ.2 are from an archived copy of the county's own FAQ, which also says no license is needed "if you are an owner-builder and only hire employees." Confirm the office and the edition at the counter. Septic: County Health Department

Unincorporated areas — verified September 2026

County	Building permit · Septic program
Gila	Building: Community Development, Building Safety — gilacountyaz.gov → Community Development → Building Safety → Adopted Building Code (a "signed Owner Builder Statement" is required) Septic: Community Development (Wastewater)
Graham	Building: Planning & Zoning — graham.az.gov/277/Planning-Zoning ("dirt work" does not require a permit, everything else does") Septic: Health Department — graham.az.gov/418/Septic-Wastewater
Greenlee	Building: Planning & Zoning — greenlee.az.gov/ova_dep/planning-and-zoning/ — where the County Engineer's "Building Codes - Load Stds" letter is posted: no code, no plan review, no inspection, no CO, and "a building permit at no cost when a Zoning Use Permit and Floodplain Permit are issued" Septic: Health Department
La Paz	Building: Community Development — Ord. 2026-01 at co.la-paz.az.us/DocumentCenter/View/9776 ("Owner's Acknowledgment & Verification of Information" form) Septic: Community Development — co.la-paz.az.us/590/SANITATION-SEPTIC, which also posts the ADEQ Notice of Intent form, the R18-9-A312(C) setback table and the well-property-line waiver form
Santa Cruz	Building: the county site refused every request in September 2026; editions in AZ.2 are from an archived copy of the county page ("Owner Builder Form"). Confirm at the counter. Septic: Environmental Health — conventional systems only; others are directed to ADEQ
Yuma	Building: Development Services — yumacountyaz.gov → Development Services → Laws & Guidelines → Building Safety Code Amendments (adopts the City of Yuma's code under § 11-861(C)(1)) Septic: Development Services, Environmental Programs

THE BIG CITIES — WHERE THE PAGE WAS READ

Nine cities whose building-code page was read directly, with the owner-builder form each names. The other eleven in AZ.2's map — Mesa, Gilbert, Peoria, Prescott, Yuma, Sierra Vista, Kingman, Surprise, Buckeye, Queen Creek, Casa Grande — file through their Development Services or Building Safety pages; their edition rows are in AZ.2.

Inside city limits — verified September 2026

City	Office · page · what it says about owners
Phoenix	Planning and Development — phoenix.gov → Planning and Development → Codes and Ordinances → Building Code. 2024 Phoenix Building Construction Code; HVAC-GFCI enforcement deferred to 1 Mar 2027
Tucson	Planning and Development Services — tucsonaz.gov → Planning and Development Services → Codes → Building Codes. "Owner/Builder Affidavit" on the Residential Permits page; rentals are commercial and need a licensed contractor

Inside city limits — verified September 2026

City	Office · page · what it says about owners
Scottsdale	scottsdaleaz.gov/codes-and-ordinances/building-codes . "Owner-Builder Declaration form" required by the Tax Audit Division
Chandler	Development Services — chandleraz.gov → Development Services → Building Safety, Plan Review, Permits and Inspections. Owner may perform the work; a leased or rented home needs a licensed contractor
Glendale	Building Safety — glendaleaz.gov/Business/Building-Safety-Codes-Services/Building-Codes . Owners doing their own work "will be required to sign verification"
Tempe	Community Development, Building Safety — tempe.gov → Community Development → Building Safety → Building Codes and Amendments. 2018/2017 accepted through 31 Dec 2026
Flagstaff	flagstaff.az.gov/5142/Building-Code . Owner Authorization form; "2024 Codes ... being evaluated"
Lake Havasu City	lhcaz.gov/593/Codes . Notarized "Owner/Builder Certification" citing § 32-1121(A)(5), at lhcaz.gov/DocumentCenter/View/1163/Owner---Builder-Certification-PDF
Goodyear	Development Services — goodyearaz.gov → Development Services → Homeowner Permit FAQs: live in it, no licensed contractor needed; rent it out, licensed contractors required

THE STATE AGENCIES — AND WHERE THE LAW ITSELF IS

Verified September 2026 — no phone numbers, by design

What you need	Where
Registrar of Contractors	roc.az.gov — license search (verify every contractor on the contract date, first-payment date and start date, § 32-1132(C)); complaints (two years from occupancy, § 32-1162(A)); the Residential Contractors' Recovery Fund; classifications at roc.az.gov/license-classifications . The Registrar licenses contractors, not you, and issues no permit
ADEQ — septic	azdeq.gov/onsite-wastewater-treatment-facilities — ADEQ's onsite wastewater page. You file with your county's delegated program (above), not with ADEQ. La Paz County posts the current Notice of Intent form (DWS 402, rev. April 2025) at co.la-paz.az.us/DocumentCenter/View/9258
ADWR — wells	azwater.gov/permitting-wells/well-drilling-arizona — ADWR's well-drilling page: the Notice of Intention to Drill and the single well license start here, and so does the question of whether your parcel sits in an active management area
Flood maps	msc.fema.gov/portal/home — the Flood Insurance Rate Map the county floodplain permit and the septic limiting-condition test both read

Verified September 2026 — no phone numbers, by design

What you need	Where
The statutes	azleg.gov/ars/<title>/<section>.htm — title unpadded, section padded to five digits: azleg.gov/ars/32/01121.htm, azleg.gov/ars/11/00321.htm; a decimal section uses a hyphen, azleg.gov/ars/9/00470-01.htm. A title's table of contents, azleg.gov/arsDetail/?title=32, shows a section published in two versions
The rules	Arizona Administrative Code, one PDF per chapter at apps.azsos.gov/public_services/Title_18/18-09.pdf (septic) — and, far easier to read, section by section at law.cornell.edu/regulations/arizona (search "R18-9-A312" or "R12-15-818")

Two offices this kit names without an address. The Industrial Commission of Arizona, for the workers' compensation question in AZ.1 — its site was not read for this pass. And Arizona 811 for utility locates before you dig — its web address did not resolve when checked on 8 September 2026; call 811 from any phone.

THE SEQUENCE, WHATEVER YOUR COUNTY

"No code" is not "no paperwork," and three of these fix things that cannot be fixed later — the recording date, the septic footprint, and the sale clock.

Eight steps, in order

	Step	Which office, and why the order
1	Record the deed	In your own name as a natural person, before any construction — the § 33-1002 owner-occupant test; nothing repairs the date later
2	Confirm the jurisdiction	City or county; the adopting ordinance number and editions; the handout; whether the counter wants the Registrar's signature on your § 32-1169 statement
3	Septic site investigation	By a registered investigator. The 100-ft well setback, the 50-ft line on a well-served lot and the 100% reserve area decide where the house and well can go — before the footprint is fixed
4	Zoning, floodplain, address	The zoning use permit on the § 11-815(B) sketch and the floodplain permit are what the county building permit issues on, even in Greenlee
5	Well notice	ADWR notice of intent with the county-health-approved site plan on five acres or less; the drilling card before the rig; or your own single well license after the exam
6	Septic Notice of Intent	To the delegated county; no construction until the Construction Authorization; two years to finish
7	Building permit	With the § 32-1169 statement naming every licensed sub. On a city permit the § 9-835 clocks start at submission; on a county permit, none does
8	Utility and 811	Ask the power company in writing what it needs before setting a meter, and call 811 before any excavation

YOUR DIRECTORY — FILL THIS IN BEFORE YOU NEED IT

Every office that touches this build, confirmed and dated

	Item	Date	Notes
☐	Jurisdiction (city or county) and its permit office; the adopting ordinance number and the editions on it; date confirmed: Jurisdiction / office _____ Ordinance _____ Editions _____ Date _____		
☐	ADEQ-delegated septic program and the registered site investigator; ADWR file number and the licensed driller or my single well license: Septic office _____ Investigator _____ ADWR file _____ Driller / license _____		
☐	Zoning office and setbacks; floodplain administrator and flood status; 911 addressing; fire district — its adopted code governs the house: Zoning office _____ Setbacks _____ Flood _____ 911 _____ Fire dist. _____		
☐	Electric utility and what it needs, in writing, before setting a meter; road authority for the driveway permit; date I called 811: Utility _____ Requires _____ Road authority _____ 811 called _____		
☐	ROC license numbers of every contractor on my § 32-1169 statement, verified on the contract, first-payment and start dates: Contractors and ROC nos. _____		

Everything cited here is free to read. Statutes are at azleg.gov, one section per page (azleg.gov/ars/32/01121.htm — title unpadded, section padded to five digits). Rules are the Arizona Administrative Code, one PDF per chapter at apps.azsos.gov and reproduced section by section at law.cornell.edu/regulations/arizona. **One warning:** the Registrar of Contractors licenses contractors, not owners, and it is not your building department — the city or county is. Read September 2026.